Evidence and Scope Addendum: source checks and honest uncertainty

Read this before reusing the 57-institution audit. This addendum clarifies specific referee concerns about documentary provenance, omitted sources, dates and interpretive thresholds. It is not a report of independent second coding, a formal reliability study, or a replacement for the original public evidence ledger.

A. Two different evidence universes

36-record chain: official national/sector/institution exemplars summarized by six L1-L4 records. 57-case panel: independently tabulated selected university cases with 20 explicit, 12 partial and 25 unlocated labels. These are not interchangeable; removing an exemplar from the 36-source register does not delete every institution-level document from the separate panel.

Scenario	36-register L4 Oman	57-panel Oman	Interpretation
Primary	E (SQU anchor)	E (SQU and Majan)	L4 evidence located in Oman.
Remove SQU from 36 only	U, L4 E in 5/6	Majan E remains	This is a 36-register-only source-deletion sensitivity, not evidence of national institutional absence.
Include Majan fallback	Cross-panel extension	E, L4 E in 6/6	The pre-cutoff Majan 2025-26 handbook provides an additional qualifying L4 instrument.

B. Source date, website date and retrieval date

The 23 July 2026 cutoff is a source issue/effective-date rule for the historical document set. An older document found after that date cannot automatically establish that its exact edition was publicly accessible on 23 July. Record three fields separately: (1) legal/issue/approval date, (2) earliest independently evidenced public-posting or archive date, and (3) researcher retrieval date. Where the second is not verifiable, label historical availability unverified; do not silently infer web visibility. Later 2026 scholarly references are background, not part of the frozen governance-source count.

C. Selected verifiable anchors and unresolved source gates

Oman / Majan University College

UG Student Handbook 2025-26, printed p. 46, §5.7.7: student assessment assistance, disclosure and misuse; original public-posting announcement 20 Oct 2025. Disposition: L4 E cross-panel corroboration. Handbook / dated announcement

Oman / Sultan Qaboos University

Quality Assurance Office lists teaching/learning/assessment GenAI guidelines; precise approved version and effective date not yet independently retrieved. Disposition: L4 source-register anchor retained provisionally; version gate HOLD. official source

Saudi Arabia / original SAU03

36-record register labels SDAIA Generative AI in Education year 2024; SDAIA publication catalogue lists a similarly titled guide dated 19 Nov 2023. Edition identity has not been reconciled. Disposition: L3 E original code CONDITIONAL. catalogue

Saudi Arabia / NeLC supplementary check

NeLC v1.0 guide p. 3 defines university/college within scope; pp. 4-7 give institutional, assessment and disclosure controls. Official 2024 annual report reports the launch. Disposition: Supports L3 applicability as additional verification, NOT silently added as a 37th original record. PDF

UAE / MoHESR OBEF

University Guidebook v11.5, 23 Mar 2026: AI readiness/teaching indicators, but no general operative AI assessment/appeal rules under stricter gate. Disposition: L3=P strict, E only under declared broader scope. PDF

Qatar / Qatar University

President-approved instructions, 25 Dec 2025, Articles 1 and 3, pp. 2-4, require disclosure and other controls; English text defers to Arabic in a conflict. Disposition: L4 E; authority, clauses and bilingual precedence identified. PDF

Reusable rules, coding boundaries and remaining holds

D. Gate decision and reason codes

E: dated authoritative instrument covers required level and specifies relevant controls. P: relevant instrument misses a required gate; record A (adoption), S (scope), C (substantive controls) or V (version/date). U: an official qualifying instrument was not recovered under recorded Arabic-English search; never equate U with absence. The P reason codes and templates are for future audit rounds, not retroactive adjudicated classifications of all 57 cases.

E. What counts at the two education levels

L3: an HE-applicable sector-level instrument (not necessarily exclusively HE-focused), with operational AI-use controls. L4: at least one adopted, university- or college-issued AI-use rule meeting the declared authority, scope and content test. These deliberately answer different existence questions; L4=E in a country does not establish sector-wide prevalence. The 36-register and 57-panel diagnostics must use an explicit universe flag.

F. Two-coder verification protocol (not executed)

1. Freeze a source table, retrieval dates, doc URLs, version IDs and a hash for every permitted local snapshot. Where redistribution rights are uncertain, preserve official URLs and hashes without republishing third-party PDFs.

2. Give two human readers the same frozen source packets and E/P/U gates; ask them to independently fill source ID, controlling text, dates, P reason and record scope without consulting initial outcomes.

3. Compute complete 3x3 confusion matrix, raw agreement, a suitable nominal agreement coefficient and unresolved source count. After a documented adjudication, recompute the six-state and 57-case summaries and publish any changes.

4. Label any document that cannot be accessed in the original edition as HOLD and separate this from U. Do not report a coder reliability value until the independent exercise really exists.

G. Sensitivity and interval bounds

Let nE and nP be the number of coded E and P jurisdictions in a layer. The P-only envelope is [nE/6, (nE+nP)/6]. For L3 it is [1/6, 3/6] and for L4 [1,1]; the minimum L4 minus L3 is 1/2. These are algebraic representations of retained coding decisions. They do not address missing U sources, uncertain editions or coder disagreement, and do not rank countries or measure confidence.

H. Practical use of the editable workbook

Begin at START HERE, then LAYER GATES; inspect 57 CASES and GCC RESULT. For a new study, fill BLANK SOURCE LOG, SEARCH TEMPLATES, TWO-CODER FORM and EIGHT PUBLIC FIELDS. The added R5 SOURCE CHECKS, R5 SCOPED TESTS and R5 P REASON CODES distinguish admitted evidence from post hoc corroboration and unresolved gates. The workbook does not generate fresh documentary labels by itself.

I. Citation and bibliographic correction

The 2017 Policy and Society introduction is coauthored by Meng-Hsuan Chou, Jens Jungblut, Pauline Ravinet and Martina Vukasovic (not Vukasovic alone), DOI 10.1080/14494035.2017.1287999. The revised manuscript corrects reference [12]. Scholar publications from August 2026 belong to the contextual literature review and do not enter the July 2026 source frame.

Remaining admission status

PARTIAL: selected source dates/clauses independently checked. HOLD: full 36-record exact-page/source-hash verification; original complete institution eligibility frame; complete historical query log; SQU precise edition; original SDAIA SAU03 year/edition; independent two-coder agreement and bilingual adjudication. The R5 manuscript must not be described as fully independently reproduced until these tasks are completed.

SUPPLEMENTARY METHODS AND REUSE KIT

From AI Strategy to University Rules in the GCC | ICAMAC 2026 Paper 90 | Evidence cutoff: 23 July 2026

Start here: what the method can and cannot answer

The Four-Layer Public-Evidence Audit (4L-PEA) is a documentary tracing protocol. It helps a reader decide whether an official, publicly inspectable AI-policy instrument meets one of four specified evidence gates. It is not a ranking of governments or universities, a legal opinion, a compliance test, or an assessment of how a rule is enforced.

Layer	Question to ask	Positive evidence required
L1	Is national AI direction public?	Official adopted/authoritative national AI direction
L2	Is there cross-sector operational AI guidance?	Inspectable national/cross-sector control or guideline
L3	Are HE-specific AI-use controls public?	HE-applicable sector instrument with substantive controls
L4	Can at least one university user locate an operative AI rule?	Applicable university or college AI rule (existence, not prevalence)

Four steps to reproduce the reasoning

1. FREEZE — Choose the jurisdiction, official institutions, bilingual search scope, classification gate and historical cutoff before examining results.

2. LOCATE — Recover the actual official document; record title, issuer, version, date, exact URL and the clause/page that supports the proposed code.

3. DECIDE — Assign E, P or U independently for every L1-L4 claim. Put any direct cross-document citation or field implementation evidence into a separate column.

4. RELEASE — Publish the source-level reasoning, negatives/uncertainty, alternative admissible interpretations and a script for count verification.

For readers of this paper: the six-state profile and 57 institution classifications describe a fixed historical evidence window. Code replays the recorded labels; it does not rediscover all websites or validate the original labels.

How to make an E/P/U coding decision

Code	Use only when...	Common error to avoid
E	A dated, inspectable official instrument has adequate authority, scope and substantive content for the layer.	Promoting an official announcement or one-course rule to sector-wide control.
P	An official AI-relevant lead exists but fails at least one named layer gate: draft, scope, authority or substantive control.	Treating all AI activity, guidance or evaluation metrics as operative rules.
U	A qualifying public instrument was not located after a documented Arabic/English official-source search.	Interpreting a failed search as proof of no internal policy or non-compliance.

Worked example: United Arab Emirates

Under the paper’s declared primary HE-use-control gate, the UAE has E / E / P / E. The fact that both national and institutional instruments are visible does not demonstrate that one caused the other.

Layer	Official evidence category	Code and reason
L1	UAE national AI strategy	E — authoritative national direction
L2	UAE AI charter	E — cross-sector governance guidance
L3	HE Outcome-Based Evaluation Framework (OBEF) v11.5	P — evaluates AI integration/readiness rather than prescribing operative HE use controls under the primary criterion
L4	United Arab Emirates University student GenAI policy	E — applicable, inspectable university rule

Sensitivity: a declared broader gate that counts sector evaluation instruments changes the UAE L3 code to E. A researcher must show that choice separately; the original primary code remains P. This does not show that a ministry instrument was transmitted to the university.

What is and is not a “policy chain”

A layer classification describes availability. A policy link requires a specific named citation, delegation or scope clause connecting two instruments. Implementation needs observations, audits, interviews or enforcement records. The study measures availability only; neither links nor actual implementation were systematically coded.

Source search, bilingual verification and audit trail

Prospective search strings that another auditor can reuse

Replace {official-domain} with an authorized ministry, regulator or university domain. These are replay templates, not a claim that every historical query used in July 2026 was preserved verbatim.

Search target	Example query family / official surface
AI rule	site:{official-domain} ("generative AI" OR "artificial intelligence") (policy OR guidelines OR regulation)
Assessment integrity	site:{university-domain} (AI OR ChatGPT) (assessment OR syllabus OR "academic integrity")
Arabic policy	site:{official-domain} + Arabic equivalents of AI, policy, regulation and guidelines (see the editable workbook for exact Arabic terms)
Archive locations	Official policy library; academic affairs; student handbook; teaching-and-learning centre; regulator indexes

Minimum fields per candidate source

Record: source ID, jurisdiction, layer, exact title, issuer, status/authority, issue and effective dates, retrieval date, controlling language, direct PDF or document URL, clause and page, proposed E/P/U, reason a gate passed/failed, known alternative edition, archival hash only if a genuine retained snapshot exists, and coder/adjudication status. A search-homepage locator cannot substitute for a qualifying policy document.

Handling Arabic and English

Compare the underlying issuer, version/approval date, scope and controlling-language clause, not just translated wording. Record the exact contested passage for each language. If a decisive disparity cannot be adjudicated from the authoritative text, mark the state as provisional; do not fabricate agreement.

When U is admissible

Record checks of official policy/regulation libraries, handbook/student conduct, assessment/integrity pages, Arabic and English domain-specific queries, and the search closing date. Distinguish a 2026 document that existed before the cutoff from a later revision introduced after the cutoff; later materials belong to another dated study window.

Research register: Open the 36-record official-source CSV (PROVISIONAL). It includes public locators and reasons but the independent verbatim passage-and-hash audit is incomplete.

Reuse checklist and independent validation plan

Eight documentary fields that make a university AI rule inspectable

Field	What a user should find
Authority and version	Who approved the applicable text, and when did it take effect?
Scope and roles	Which users, programmes, assignments and activities fall under it?
Assessment permissions	What AI use is permitted, conditional or forbidden?
Disclosure	How must users acknowledge AI involvement?
Tools and data	What tools, privacy categories or data transfers are restricted?
Human verification	Who verifies outputs and remains accountable?
Fairness and appeals	Where are bias, accessibility and challenge provisions?
Maintenance and review	Who updates the rule and how is the newest text identified?

Status: these fields are a practical documentation proposal, not an empirical eight-factor model, a weighted ranking, a compliance certificate or a validated policy-quality score. The editable workbook includes a blank locator and status for each field.

Independent double-coding: an unexecuted verification protocol

Freeze and time-stamp the source set. Give two independent human coders the same gatebook and blinded order. Each coder records the E/P/U state, source/page, authority, scope and language decision. Report a 3-by-3 confusion matrix, paired raw agreement, Cohen’s kappa (where defined), all disagreements, and the adjudicated outcome. Recalculate the public matrix only after documenting any changed label. This did not occur in the reported results.

Materials and boundaries

Research package (author-linked GitHub) includes the 57-case key, current manuscript, source metadata, result checks and code. Open the 57-row institution CSV. The complete original pre-outcome eligibility universe and full 36-source archival/coder validation are not supplied. No archival DOI or formal author-approved license is asserted.

Next pages: the original 57-institution appendix with clickable official evidence/search locators. Context/search URLs attached to U cases are explicitly not positive policy evidence.

57 institutions — readable source locator key

Paper 90 • Locked labels and retained official links • Part 1 of 4 • Evidence cutoff: 23 July 2026

E = qualifying explicit evidence; P = relevant but subthreshold evidence; U = qualifying evidence not located under the historical search. U does not mean that no internal policy exists. These links are inherited evidence/search locators, not a freshly verified live-web audit. Full institution names below expand the submitted abbreviated labels; category, order and URL are unchanged.

No.	State	Jur.	Institution (full display name)	Retained locator
1	E	AE	United Arab Emirates University	Open official locator
2	E	AE	University of Sharjah	Open official locator
3	E	AE	Zayed University	Open official locator
4	U	AE	University of Khorfakkan	Open official locator
5	U	AE	Emirates Institute for Banking and Financial Studies (EIBFS)	Open official locator
6	E	AE	Ajman University	Open official locator
7	P	AE	University of Wollongong in Dubai	Open official locator
8	P	AE	American University in Dubai	Open official locator
9	U	AE	Fatima College of Health Sciences	Open official locator
10	U	AE	Emirates College for Advanced Education	Open official locator
11	U	AE	Abu Dhabi Polytechnic	Open official locator
12	P	AE	Al Qasimia University	Open official locator
13	E	AE	Rabdan Academy	Open official locator
14	E	SA	King Saud University	Open official locator
15	E	SA	King Abdulaziz University	Open official locator

57 institutions — readable source locator key

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The state is an evidential classification, not a policy-quality rank. Open the source link to inspect the authority, edition and scope; a U-case link may point to a search/context page and cannot establish a positive rule.

No.	State	Jur.	Institution (full display name)	Retained locator
16	U	SA	Imam Mohammad Ibn Saud Islamic University	Open official locator
17	P	SA	King Faisal University	Open official locator
18	U	SA	Dar Al-Hekma University	Open official locator
19	U	SA	Effat University	Open official locator
20	E	SA	Prince Sultan University	Open official locator
21	P	SA	University of Business and Technology	Open official locator
22	P	SA	Islamic University of Madinah	Open official locator
23	P	SA	King Fahd University of Petroleum and Minerals	Open official locator
24	U	SA	King Saud bin Abdulaziz University for Health Sciences	Open official locator
25	E	QA	Qatar University	Open official locator
26	U	QA	Community College of Qatar	Open official locator
27	E	QA	Virginia Commonwealth University School of the Arts in Qatar	Open official locator
28	U	QA	Al Rayyan International University College	Open official locator
29	P	QA	Weill Cornell Medicine-Qatar	Open official locator

57 institutions — readable source locator key

Paper 90 • Locked labels and retained official links • Part 3 of 4 • Evidence cutoff: 23 July 2026

The state is an evidential classification, not a policy-quality rank. Open the source link to inspect the authority, edition and scope; a U-case link may point to a search/context page and cannot establish a positive rule.

No.	State	Jur.	Institution (full display name)	Retained locator
30	P	QA	Texas A&M University at Qatar	Open official locator
31	U	QA	Qatar Aeronautical Academy	Open official locator
32	U	QA	Qatar Olympic Academy	Open official locator
33	U	QA	Qatar Leadership Centre	Open official locator
34	U	QA	Qatar Finance and Business Academy	Open official locator
35	E	OM	Sultan Qaboos University	Open official locator
36	E	OM	Majan University College	Open official locator
37	U	OM	Modern College of Business and Science	Open official locator
38	P	OM	Muscat College	Open official locator
39	U	OM	Sohar University	Open official locator
40	U	OM	College of Sharia Sciences	Open official locator
41	U	OM	Oman College of Health Sciences	Open official locator
42	U	OM	University of Technology and Applied Sciences	Open official locator
43	E	BH	University of Bahrain	Open official locator

57 institutions — readable source locator key

Paper 90 • Locked labels and retained official links • Part 4 of 4 • Evidence cutoff: 23 July 2026

The state is an evidential classification, not a policy-quality rank. Open the source link to inspect the authority, edition and scope; a U-case link may point to a search/context page and cannot establish a positive rule.

No.	State	Jur.	Institution (full display name)	Retained locator
44	E	BH	Bahrain Institute of Banking and Finance	Open official locator
45	E	BH	Ahlia University	Open official locator
46	E	BH	Gulf University	Open official locator
47	U	BH	Kingdom University	Open official locator
48	E	BH	Arabian Gulf University	Open official locator
49	E	BH	Bahrain Polytechnic	Open official locator
50	E	KW	Kuwait University	Open official locator
51	U	KW	Abdullah Al-Salem University	Open official locator
52	U	KW	Arab Open University-Kuwait	Open official locator
53	E	KW	Gulf University for Science and Technology	Open official locator
54	P	KW	American University of Kuwait	Open official locator
55	P	KW	Australian University	Open official locator
56	U	KW	Public Authority for Applied Education and Training	Open official locator
57	U	KW	Kuwait Academy of Arts	Open official locator